TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JUNE 9 , 2021
6:30 PM
REVISED

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Pro-temp Williams calls meeting to order at 6:30 pm.

   Those in attendance were Council Members: Dana Williams, David Crenshaw, Larry Ward, John Henry, Brooks Barbaree and Ed Drohan. Staff in attendance were: Police Chief, Sean Clayton; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman; Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby; Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Accounts Payable/Utility Manager, Katina Spaulding; Finance Administrator Shelly Jameson and Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion.

   Mayor Goette had an emergency and left before meeting was called to order.

   Mayor Pro-tem Williams welcomed two new staff members: Town Administrator, Bob Milie and Finance Administrator, Shelly Jameson.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Pro-tem Williams asked for a motion to approve the agenda. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Henry. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of May 12, 2021

   Mayor Pro-tem Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes from May 12th. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

Discussion Agenda

5. **Approval of Pretty Darn Clean Pressure Washing Home Occupation Permit**

   Alex Duncan was present. He explained he is starting this business to provide for his family. His home will be used as an office. Mayor Pro-tem Williams asked about traffic of clients and equipment on site. All work will be done off property and he ha a trailer and truck. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Henry.** Town Administrator Milie asked about neighbors. Town Clerk Denion

stated she gathers the adjacent property owner information to insure it is owners not renters. **The motion passed unanimously.**

6. **Approval of a Sprinkler System Variance for Desposito's**
Michelle Cooley, managing partner of Despositos and Nathan Pollard, architect with Raymond, LLC was present to explain their request. Mr. Pollard explained they need a variance for the sprinkler system requirement. He explained they are not changing the use or the footprint of the building. There is no municipal water or sewer. Mayor Pro-tem Williams asked about fire suppression in the kitchen. Mr. Pollard stated it would have a fire suppression system such as Halon. Mayor Pro-tem Williams asked how many points of egress. Mr. Pollard said three. Mayor Pro-tem Williams asked Chief Bateman his recommendation of the request. Chief Bateman stated as long as they have an alarm system, he was fine with the request. Mayor Pro-temp asked Building Inspector Fischer his recommendation. Mr. Fischer stated it is not required by state code and they are not changing size or use, so if Council wishes to grant the variance it would not cause more of a safety issue. Council Member Crenshaw asked about their water source. Mr. Pollard stated it is a well. Council Member Drohan asked if this sprinkler ordinance was due to building code from a few years ago Council adopted. Mr. Fischer stated no. **Council Member Drohan motion to approve the variance with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously**

7. **Approval of Finches Alcohol License to include Liquor**

Jamie Pleta from Finches came forward and explained Finches wishes to add to their current alcohol permit to include liquor by the drink. Town Attorney Barrow asked about the distance between Finches and the Church on the corner. Ms. Pleta stated it is 101 yards. Town Clerk Denion stated the State law requires 100 yards from a church. Council Member **Barbaree made the motion to approve the liquor license with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Approval of Finches Outdoor Event Permit**

Jamie Pleta explained Finches wishes to add small community events with music throughout the year. Council Member Henry stated the application showed music stopping at 5:45 pm and asked about the time. Ms. Pleta stated these events will not go into the night. They wish to go home and sleep in their own beds. Town Clerk Denion stated she spoke with Chief Clayton about any issues so far with market day and Chief Clayton stated they have off duty officers and Finches has always worked **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the outdoor permit request with a second by Council Member Crenshaw seconded. The motion passed unanimously.**

9. **Approval of New Planning & Zoning Appointment of Daniel Host @ 2902 River Dr. C201**

Town Clerk Denion explained there were two applications submitted for vacancy on Planning and Zoning, Rachel Perkins from Mariners Square and Daniel Host. The Planning and Zoning Commission selected Mr. Host as their choice. Council needs to approve their recommendation. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve the appointment of Daniel Hose to the Planning and Zoning Commission with a second by Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously**

10. **Planning and Zoning:**

a) **Petitioner:** William E. Griffin
Request: Front Set Back Variance
Parcel Involved: 3-0006-10-002
Location: 3108 Gilbert Street
P & Z approved unanimously

William Griffin of 3108 Gilbert Street was present and spoke to Council about his petition. He has returned to Thunderbolt to live in his family home. The home was built in 1965. As part of the remodeling, he would like to add a porch on the front of the house. The porch would encroach into the 25 ft front setback by five feet. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve the variance with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

Jenna Wheeler was asked to come forward and explain about Lemonade Day. Lemonade Day is a day for kids to set up stands and promote entrepreneurship. She had petitioned to be on the agenda but due to time constraints was not placed on the agenda. Several Council Members had questions about the program and asked her to come back to the July Meeting.

11. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie stated he has been on the job for 10 days. His main focus is to identify the vision of each Council Member has for the Town. He is going over the budget and getting a feel of the flow of the town. He has met all the staff and has been amazed at what employees have on their plate.

12. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police
Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

13. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**
    a) First Reading of the Smoking Ban Ordinance

Town Attorney Barrow explained to Council this is a first reading of what he has called a Smoking Ban and what was before them was informational.

Mayor Pro-Tem Williams asked Past Mayor Thomas to update the Council on the Thunderbolt Museum. "Jenny" is being refurbished by Comandos. It will take some time. The Museum welcomes donations and time toward the refurbishing of "Jenny". The museum is currently closed. There have been several deaths and sickness in the group. The museum needs people for the Board. The Board meets once a month. They are meeting soon to discuss time and days to open back up.

14. **Mayor and Council –**

    a) **Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan**

Council Member Drohan made a motion that prior to the July 14, 2021 Town Council Meeting that there be an hour-long workshop, open to the public, where an agenda will be developed for subsequent public town hall meetings focused on the development of ta comprehensive conservation, pricing and waste management program for the Town of Thunderbolt. Council Member Henry seconded the motion. Council Member Drohan stated the following is a result of a consideration of research that he's done over the weekend regarding this topic. I would appreciate your feedback.

Areas of the United States with drier environments have engaged in statewide programs to encourage municipalities to promote conservation efforts in a way that impact water consumption in measurable and functional ways. San Antonio, Texas for example has experienced growth rates as high as 80% with water use increasing only 20%.

I have borrowed the information below from a Texas website and edited it to use as a working document as we continue to address the water and sewer challenges in Thunderbolt. The categories below are not new to us but emphasize that the goals of water management are ongoing and require revisitation in order to deal with the reality of an ever-diminishing resource that is water.

1. Implement fair water rate structures

Utilities should have a strong tiered-rate structure with affordable prices for those who use water efficiently, and significantly higher water rates for customers who use excessive amounts of water. The additional revenue generated should be dedicated to funding water conservation programs.

2. Establish water conservation goals

In Texas, cities are required to create conservation plans with water use reduction goals; however, many cities set easily achievable but not very impressive targets. Water utilities with relatively moderate rates of water use should set goals that meet the 1 percent annual reduction/140 gallons per capita per day (gpcd) (a recommendation made by the Texas Water Development Board Water Conservation Implementation Task Force). Utilities with higher rates of water use should set more aggressive goals.

Our history in Thunderbolt indicates that we are in the higher rate level regionally due primarily by the dependency on relatively costly supply and service provision from the City of Savannah for surplus demand beyond our aquifer withdrawal limits and all of our sewerage treatment requirements. Conservation is the primary tool for reducing demand for aquifer water resources and therefore reducing our dependency on Savannah and the significantly higher costs associated with that dependency.

3. Implement toilet replacement programs

New high-efficiency toilets can save 12,000 gallons annually over older models. In Thunderbolt, we should tap into this low-priced and reliable water source by replacing as many pre-1992 toilets as is practical and cost effective. The replacement inefficient toilets should be seen as a central feature of our infrastructure plan utilizing a focused, effective and impactful conservation program.

4. Fund water conservation efforts

The Ad Hoc Committee for Water and Sewer has functioned for nearly 8 years as prime motivator for successful structural changes in our infrastructure. Our efforts towards the implementation of conservation of water resources has been primarily educational, utilizing the monthly billings to advise and encourage residents regarding effective conservation practices.

For the eight months remaining in the tenure of the current Ad Hoc Committee, I want to recommend establishing regular meetings where the citizens are invited to participate in the discussions of the full scope of the dangers of a less than aggressive move towards improved water conservation in Thunderbolt.

Steps towards water conservation should be aggressive and incorporated into the water rate structure. The rate structure should reflect a cost for those who choose to not participate in conservation as their behaviors negatively impact each other resident in town. This could serve as a set aside source of income that would focus upon the structural costs associated with an effective water conservation program. I believe that water conservation should be a separate line item in the budget and Thunderbolt should make sure conservation dollars are used effectively.

5. Adopt outdoor watering ordinances

To ensure that water for landscaping is used as effectively as possible, Thunderbolt should encourage lawn watering based on recommendations from the GA-EPA. Landscape watering during the heat of the day should be prohibited throughout the year.

Use of shallow wells should be promoted and should be considered in the rate structure of the Town.

6. Establish retrofit programs

A standard showerhead purchased today will save customers roughly three gallons per minute. Thunderbolt should take advantage of the dependable water savings from such new technologies by creating cost-effective retrofit programs.

7. Educate the public

Educating the public about ways to use water efficiently can reduce water use, build public support for additional conservation measures, and improve a utility's image as a wise steward of our natural resources.

The conservation meetings recommended above are in my estimation a central feature of expanding public knowledge and participation in our goal for effective use of water resources.

Council Member Drohan made a motion to have the Town Administrator explore the costs related to expanding the concrete slabs located at Nelly Johnson Park and the Cicerone ballfield so that they might therefore be large enough o contain two pickleball courts, each as well as to determine the material costs to install those courts utilizing volunteer citizen labor. It is further moved that the Town Administrator explore the costs relative to the installation of a beach volleyball facility at the Cicerone Ballfield including sand, poles and net again utilizing volunteer citizen labor. Furthermore, these anticipated improvements shall be advertised on the town website as well as included in the water bills for July and August requesting participation from interested townspeople. Council Member Ward seconded the motion. Council Member Henry asked if citizens were going to be asked about pickleball? Town Administrator Milie asked Council to table this item until an overall plan for all parks and recreation be developed. He would report to Council by the next meeting on this item. Council Member Crenshaw agreed with Town Administrator Milie. **Council Member Drohan amended the motion to add information to the website. Council Member Ward motioned to accept the amendment with a second by Council Member Drohan. The amendment was unanimously approved. Council Drohan made the motion to approve the new amended motion with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

Council Member Drohan wanted to follow up with a motion made to initiate discussions with the City of Savannah regarding the north sewer line. motion push to initiate contact with Savannah.
Council Member Drohan made a fourth motion to ask Town Administrator to initiate conversations with the management of River Supply and the appropriate representatives of the Chatham County Board of Education to begin discussions regarding shared costs for the purposed of improving those sections of Tuberson Ave adjacent to River Supply and Shell Road adjacent to Johnson High School in a manner that will allow those sections of those roads to be adequately strengthened so as to manage the regular and significant commercial/institutional traffic along these thoroughfares that are required by these two entities. Town Administrator Milie points out this should not be a motion. Council has the right to direct him to look into any project.

Mayor Pro-tem Williams stated he can't say enough about staff and what a great job they do especially during staff shortage keeping the Town moving forward.

Council Member Henry made a motion to go into Executive Session to discuss legal, personnel and real estate. Council Member Drohan seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.

15. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal, Real Estate and/or Personnel matters.

Mayor Pro-tem asked for a motion to reconvene into the regular meeting. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

Mayor Pro-tem asked for a motion to adjourn. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

16. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 7:37 pm.

Mayor, Beth E. Goette

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion